BOTANORA

N° 01



Signature Infusions

40 barista-style teas and infusions made from your pantry

PDF GUIDE · 40 PAGES

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40 barista-style teas and infusions made from your pantry

This book gathers 40 recipes built entirely from your pantry. None needs special equipment: a pan, a sieve, a grater and two mugs are enough.

The recipes were designed the way a barista designs a menu: every drink has a base (black tea, rooibos, herbs or spices), an aromatic layer (fruit, citrus, flower) and a finish (honey, zest, ground spice). Understanding that structure is what lets you improvise later.

Most are hot. There are 4 iced drinks for warm days and 6 creamy ones with milk, all adapted to foam without a steamer or whisk. 30 of the 40 recipes are caffeine-free.

Measures: 1 tsp ≈ 5 ml · 1 tbsp ≈ 15 ml · 1 cup ≈ 250 ml · "1 serving of rooibos moon" = 1 bag or 1 tbsp loose leaf.



01

Read the technique

The temperature and timing pages apply to everything. Ten minutes of reading saves many bitter cups.

02

Make the bases

Spiced syrup and ginger honey keep for weeks and speed up everyday brewing.

03

Adjust to taste

Honey and steep times are suggestions. Taste before sweetening.

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CHAPTER ZERO

The pantry

Eighteen ingredients, each with a role. Knowing how each behaves in water is the foundation of every recipe.

Rooibos moon
Caffeine-free base, sweet and woody. Handles boiling and long steeps.

Chamomile (flowers)
Floral and honeyed. Water at ≈ 95 °C, always covered.

Hibiscus flowers
Acidity and ruby colour. Extracts fast: 2 to 5 min.

Mint (bags)
Minty freshness; softens perceived acidity.

Rosehip, hibiscus & cherry
Ready-made tart fruit, great for layering.

Star anise
Liquorice and sweetness. Decoction: needs simmering.

Ground cinnamon
Aromatic finish on top of the drink.

Honey
Sweetens and rounds. Always add off the boil.

Apple
Sweetness and body. Raw, stewed, toasted or caramelised.

Black tea
Structure, malt and tannins. Short steep: 3 to 4 min.

Lemongrass
Citrus without acidity: the "lemon" that works with milk.

Hibiscus (bags)
A handy, milder version of the flower.

Fennel (bags)
Natural sweetness, liquorice notes. After-meal friendly.

Camomile & lemongrass
Ready-made floral-citrus blend.

Cinnamon sticks
Sweet wood. Simmer to extract; doubles as a stirrer.

Ginger (root)
Warmth and heat. Sliced = clean; grated = intense.

Lime
Peel = aroma; juice = acidity. Always last.

Whole milk
Body and creaminess. Never boil, never with acid.

PAIRINGS THAT WORK

- Black tea + cinnamon + anise
- Rooibos + apple
- Chamomile + honey + lime
- Hibiscus + ginger
- Lemongrass + mint
- Rooibos + chamomile
- Fennel + anise
- Black tea + milk + spices

AVOID

- Milk + lime
- Milk + hibiscus
- Honey in boiling water
- Squeezing bags
- Black tea for more than 5 min

TECHNIQUE

Temperature and time, no thermometer

Two numbers define a good cup: how hot the water is and how long it works. Without a thermometer, read the pan.

WATER STAGE	TEMPERATURE	USE FOR
Full boil	100 °C	Rooibos, dried herbs, hibiscus, spices, ginger
Rested 30 s	≈ 95 °C	Black tea
Rested 1 min	≈ 90 a 95 °C	Chamomile, rosehip, floral blends
Steaming	≈ 65 a 70 °C	Milk, never boil
Warm	≈ 50 °C	Time to add honey and lime

STEEP TIMES

INGREDIENT	TIME	NOTE
Black tea	3 a 4 min	More than 5 min turns bitter
Rooibos	5 a 8 min	Does not turn bitter
Chamomile	5 a 6 min	Covered
Lemongrass	5 min	Covered
Hibiscus (flower)	2 a 5 min	Extracts very fast
Herb bags	4 a 5 min	Do not squeeze
Whole spices	4 a 6 min	Simmering (decoction)
Ginger	3 a 8 min	Simmering; see ruler in chapter V

INFUSION

Hot water over the ingredient, heat off. For leaves and flowers: black tea, chamomile, lemongrass, hibiscus, bags.

DECOCTION

The ingredient simmers in the water. For hard things: cinnamon sticks, star anise, ginger, apple. In mixed recipes, the decoction comes first and the infusion after.

TECHNIQUE

Golden rules

1. **Cover the herbs.** Chamomile and lemongrass aromas are volatile and evaporate.
2. **Do not squeeze bags.** The last liquid in the bag is concentrated bitter tannin.
3. **Honey and lime last**, off the heat, once the drink is warm.
4. **Warm the cup** with hot water before serving: the drink keeps its temperature and aroma.
5. **Taste before sweetening.** Fennel, rooibos and apple already bring natural sweetness.

A good drink has three layers: base, aroma and finish. Adjust one at a time.

Minimum equipment

- A small lidded pan (decoctions and milk).
- A fine sieve (loose leaf, grated ginger, spices).
- A fine grater (zest and ginger).
- Two mugs with handles (foam for the creamy drinks).
- A lidded glass jar (syrups and cold brew).

MISE EN PLACE

Base preparations

As in a café, some preparations are ready before service. They shorten brewing and lift the finish of many recipes.

Spiced honey syrup

Makes ≈ 180 ml · 2 weeks in the fridge

Ingredients. 100 ml water, 100 ml honey, 1 cinnamon stick, 2 star anise.

Method. Simmer the water with the spices for 5 min. Turn off, wait 2 min and stir in the honey. Store with the spices in a glass jar. 1 tbsp per cup.

Ginger honey

Makes ≈ 80 ml · 2 weeks in the fridge

Ingredients. 4 tbsp honey, 1 heaped tbsp grated ginger, 1 strip of lime peel.

Method. Warm everything over the lowest heat for 2 min without boiling. Rest 1 h and strain. A shortcut for the Elixir, the Toddy and Ember.

Caramelised apple

Fresh · 3 min

¼ apple, diced or sliced, 1 tsp honey, 1 pinch ground cinnamon. Pan over medium heat, apple and honey together, stirring until golden and glossy. Cinnamon at the end.

A garnish, cup base or topping for the creamy drinks.

Charred lime

Fresh · 2 min

Thick lime wheels (≈ 1 cm). Very hot dry pan, 1 min per side, until marked. Do not move them while they colour.

Softer acidity and marmalade notes.

Hibiscus ice

1 tray · 4 h in the freezer

1 tbsp hibiscus flowers, 250 ml boiling water, 1 tbsp honey. Steep 5 min, strain, sweeten and cool. Freeze in a tray.

Chills iced drinks without diluting and colours the glass.

Citrus ribbons and zest

Fresh

A well-washed lime. With the grater, green part only (the pith is bitter). For ribbons, use a knife and cut thin strips without pith.

Twist over the cup: the oils land on the surface.

QUICK PICK

What to drink now?

A shortcut by moment of the day. The numbers on the right take you straight to the recipe page.

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CHAPTER I

Black Tea

Body & Structure

Black tea is the backbone of classic blends: firm tannins and notes of malt and wood that carry spices, fruit and citrus. Here it is treated like an espresso: a concentrated base that takes aromatic layers.

01 Imperial Spiced Black

02 Black Tea & Toasted Apple

03 Barista's Toddy

04 Dark Ruby

05 Citrus Black with Lemongrass

06 Iced Black with Lime & Honey

07 Double Anise



01 Imperial Spiced Black

Malt, sweet wood and a long anise finish.

Hot · 9 min · 1 cup · 250 ml · Caffeinated · Easy

INGREDIENTS

300 ml	water
1 bag	black tea
1 stick (5 cm)	cinnamon stick
1	star anise
1 tsp	honey

Finish. The star anise itself floating in the cup.

METHOD

1. Simmer the water with the cinnamon and anise for 4 min, low heat, lid on. Hard spices need a decoction, not an infusion.
2. Turn off the heat and wait 30 s (≈ 95 °C). Add the bag and steep 3 min, covered.
3. Lift out the bag without squeezing: squeezing releases bitter tannins. Strain the spices.
4. Sweeten with the honey off the heat.

BARISTA TIP Toast the cinnamon and anise for 40 s in the dry pan before adding water: the essential oils intensify.

02 Black Tea & Toasted Apple

Caramel, baked apple skin, full-bodied tea.

Hot · 10 min · 1 cup · 250 ml · Caffeinated · Intermediate

INGREDIENTS

¼	apple, thinly sliced
1 pinch	ground cinnamon
280 ml	water
1 bag	black tea
1 tsp	honey

Finish. Toasted apple slice on the rim.

METHOD

1. Brown the apple slices in a dry pan over medium heat, about 2 min per side. Dust with cinnamon in the last minute.
2. Put half the slices in the pot or mug, add the bag and pour over the boiling water. Steep 3 min.
3. Remove the bag and leave the apple for 2 more min.
4. Sweeten and clip a toasted slice on the rim of the cup.

BARISTA TIP The Maillard reaction in the apple creates baked-pie notes that the malt of black tea embraces beautifully.

03 Barista's Toddy

An alcohol-free hot toddy: citrusy, spicy, comforting.

Hot · 8 min · 1 cup · 250 ml · Caffeinated · Easy

INGREDIENTS

250 ml	water
1 bag	black tea
1 tsp	grated ginger
1 stick	cinnamon stick
1 tbsp	lime juice
1 tbsp	honey

Finish. A lime wheel and the cinnamon stick as a stirrer.

METHOD

1. Simmer the water with the ginger and cinnamon for 3 min.
2. Turn off the heat, add the bag and steep 3 min.
3. In the cup, dissolve the honey in the lime juice.
4. Strain the tea over the mixture and stir.

BARISTA TIP Citrus always goes in last and off the heat: direct heat dulls the freshness and makes it taste "cooked".

04 Dark Ruby

Tannic and fruity, garnet in colour, cranberry-like acidity.

Hot · 7 min · 1 cup · 250 ml · Caffeinated · Easy

INGREDIENTS

250 ml	water
1 bag	black tea
1 level tsp	dried hibiscus flowers
1 strip	lime peel
2 tsp	honey

Finish. Serve in a glass cup to show off the colour.

METHOD

1. Pour boiling water over the hibiscus and lime peel. Steep 2 min.
2. Add the black tea bag and steep 3 more min.
3. Strain and sweeten.

BARISTA TIP Hibiscus extracts very fast. Past 5 min alongside black tea, two astringencies add up and the cup turns harsh.

05 Citrus Black with Lemongrass

Light and fragrant, like a tropical Earl Grey.

Hot · 8 min · 1 cup · 250 ml · Caffeinated · Easy

INGREDIENTS

250 ml	water
1 bag	black tea
1 tbsp	dried lemongrass
¼	lime (zest only)
1 tsp	honey

Finish. Lime zest on the surface.

METHOD

1. Steep the lemongrass in boiling water for 3 min.
2. Add the black tea bag for 3 more min. Strain.
3. Zest the lime straight over the cup, green part only.
4. Sweeten.

BARISTA TIP Zesting over the drink, not into the pan, lands the peel oils on the surface: it is the aroma you meet before the first sip.

06 Iced Black with Lime & Honey

Refreshing, citrusy, with a clean, dry finish.

Iced · 15 min · 1 glass · 300 ml · Caffeinated · Easy

INGREDIENTS

2 bags	black tea
200 ml	boiling water
2 tbsp	honey
2 tbsp	lime juice
to taste	ice
2 wheels	lime

Finish. Lime wheels between the ice cubes.

METHOD

1. Steep both bags in the 200 ml of water for 4 min: a double concentrate, because the ice will dilute it.
2. Remove the bags and dissolve the honey while hot.
3. Let it cool for 10 min and add the lime juice.
4. Fill a glass with ice and the lime wheels and pour in the tea. Stir for 15 s.

BARISTA TIP Black tea chilled while hot can turn cloudy. Pouring it warm straight over plenty of ice prevents it.

07 Double Anise

Natural sweetness of fennel, liquorice and malt.

Hot · 9 min · 1 cup · 250 ml · Caffeinated · Easy

INGREDIENTS

280 ml	water
1 bag	black tea
1 bag	fennel tea
1	star anise
½ tsp	honey (optional)

Finish. A whole star anise on the saucer.

METHOD

1. Simmer the anise in the water for 3 min.
2. Turn off the heat, add both bags and steep 4 min, covered.
3. Strain and taste before sweetening: fennel already brings sweetness.

BARISTA TIP Star anise and fennel share the same aromatic compound (anethole). Together, each amplifies the other.

CHAPTER II

Rooibos Moon

Amber & Sweetness

Rooibos is naturally caffeine-free, sweetish and woody, with notes of vanilla and honey. It does not turn bitter with long steeps, which makes it perfect for concentrating, pairing with fruit and serving at night.

08 Apple Pie in a Pot

09 Amber Rooibos

10 Dusk

11 Ember

12 Starry Rooibos

13 Rooibos & Apple Cold Brew

14 Full Moon



08 Apple Pie in a Pot

Stewed apple, cinnamon and the woody depth of rooibos.

Hot · 12 min · 1 cup · 250 ml · Caffeine-free · Easy

INGREDIENTS

300 ml	water
1 serving	rooibos moon
¼	apple, diced
1 stick	cinnamon stick
1 pinch	ground cinnamon
1 tsp	honey

Finish. Ground cinnamon on one side of the surface.

METHOD

1. Simmer the apple and cinnamon stick in the water for 5 min.
2. Turn off the heat, add the rooibos and steep 6 min, covered.
3. Strain, pressing the apple lightly.
4. Sweeten and dust with ground cinnamon.

BARISTA TIP Rooibos does not turn bitter with time: here it can stay up to 8 min for a denser cup.

09 Amber Rooibos

Toasted honey with caramel notes and a touch of citrus.

Hot · 10 min · 1 cup · 250 ml · Caffeine-free · Technique

INGREDIENTS

1 tbsp	honey
280 ml	water
1 serving	rooibos moon
1 strip	lime peel

Finish. A strip of lime peel twisted over the cup.

METHOD

1. Warm the honey in a small pan over low heat until it bubbles and darkens slightly (1 to 2 min). It should smell of caramel.
2. Pour in the water carefully (it will hiss), add the lime peel and bring to the boil.
3. Turn off the heat, add the rooibos and steep 6 min.
4. Strain and serve.

BARISTA TIP Toasted honey loses some sweetness and gains an elegant bitterness. Take it off before it gets too dark: past amber, it turns bitter.

10 Dusk

A sweet, woody base topped with cherry and rosehip.

Hot · 7 min · 1 cup · 280 ml · Caffeine-free · Easy

INGREDIENTS

300 ml	boiling water
1 serving	rooibos moon
1 bag	rosehip, hibiscus & cherry
1 tsp	honey
1 slice	apple

Finish. A thin apple slice floating.

METHOD

1. Pour the water over the rooibos and the fruit bag.
2. Remove the fruit bag at 4 min; leave the rooibos up to 6 min.
3. Strain, sweeten and finish with the apple slice.

BARISTA TIP Removing the fruit bag first keeps the balance: acidity on top, sweetness underneath.

11 Ember

Clean ginger heat over rooibos and honey.

Hot · 11 min · 1 cup · 250 ml · Caffeine-free · Easy

INGREDIENTS

300 ml	water
1 serving	rooibos moon
4 slices	ginger
1 tsp	honey
1 pinch	ground cinnamon

Finish. A ginger slice on the rim.

METHOD

1. Simmer the ginger in the water for 4 min.
2. Turn off the heat, add the rooibos and steep 6 min.
3. Strain, sweeten and dust with cinnamon.

BARISTA TIP Sliced ginger gives clean heat and a clear cup; grated is stronger and cloudier. Choose by your mood.

12 Starry Rooibos

Vanilla and liquorice: a sugar-free dessert.

Hot · 10 min · 1 cup · 250 ml · Caffeine-free · Easy

INGREDIENTS

300 ml	water
1 serving	rooibos moon
1 bag	fennel tea
1	star anise
½ tsp	honey (optional)

Finish. Star anise on the saucer.

METHOD

1. Simmer the anise in the water for 3 min.
2. Turn off the heat, add the rooibos and fennel and steep 6 min, covered.
3. Strain and taste before sweetening.

BARISTA TIP The natural sweetness of rooibos plus fennel usually makes honey unnecessary. Try it plain first.

13 Rooibos & Apple Cold Brew

Cold extraction: smooth, sweet, almost tannin-free.

Iced · 5 min + 8 h · 2 glasses · 500 ml · Caffeine-free · Intermediate

INGREDIENTS

2 servings	rooibos moon
500 ml	cold filtered water
½	apple, sliced
1 stick	cinnamon stick
2 tsp	honey
to taste	ice

Finish. Apple slice and the cinnamon stick in the glass.

METHOD

1. In a jug, combine the rooibos, water, apple and cinnamon. Refrigerate for 8 to 12 h.
2. Strain.
3. Dissolve the honey in 1 tbsp hot water before adding: honey does not dissolve in the cold.
4. Serve over ice with an apple slice.

BARISTA TIP Cold extraction pulls fewer tannins and more sugars: the result is naturally sweeter than the hot version.

14 Full Moon

Chamomile florals over a base of honey and wood.

Hot · 8 min · 1 cup · 250 ml · Caffeine-free · Easy

INGREDIENTS

300 ml	water
1 serving	rooibos moon
1 tbsp	chamomile flowers
1 tsp	honey
optional	lime zest

Finish. A few whole chamomile flowers on the surface.

METHOD

1. Boil the water, turn off and wait 1 min (≈ 95 °C).
2. Steep the rooibos and chamomile for 5 min, covered.
3. Strain and sweeten.

BARISTA TIP The lid traps chamomile's volatile oils, which evaporate easily. Uncovered, half the aroma is gone.

CHAPTER III

Florals & Herbs

Calm & Fragrance

Chamomile, lemongrass, mint and fennel make up the tisane family: caffeine-free, aromatic and delicate. These drinks want gentler heat and shorter times, and fragrance is the star.

15 Golden Chamomile

16 Orchard at Sunset

17 Breeze

18 Fresh Garden

19 Serene Trio

20 Chamomile & Charred Lime

21 Chef's Digestif



15 Golden Chamomile

Honey, sweet hay and citrus zest.

Hot · 7 min · 1 cup · 250 ml · Caffeine-free · Easy

INGREDIENTS

250 ml	water
2 tbsp	chamomile flowers
1 tsp	honey
⅛	lime (zest only)

Finish. Fine lime zest and one whole flower.

METHOD

1. Boil the water, turn off and wait 1 min (≈ 95 °C).
2. Steep the flowers for 5 min, covered.
3. Strain, sweeten and zest the lime over the top.

BARISTA TIP Whole flowers give a sweeter, honeyed cup than bags, where chamomile comes crushed.

16 Orchard at Sunset

Chamomile and stewed apple: sweet, floral, soft.

Hot · 11 min · 1 cup · 250 ml · Caffeine-free · Easy

INGREDIENTS

300 ml	water
¼	apple, sliced
1½ tbsp	chamomile flowers
1 pinch	ground cinnamon
1 tsp	honey

Finish. Apple slice and cinnamon.

METHOD

1. Simmer the apple in the water for 4 min.
2. Turn off, wait 1 min and add the chamomile. Steep 5 min, covered.
3. Strain, sweeten and dust with cinnamon.

BARISTA TIP "Chamomile" comes from the Greek for "ground apple", after the flowers' scent. The pairing is almost natural.

17 Breeze

Citrusy lemongrass with ginger warmth.

Hot · 10 min · 1 cup · 250 ml · Caffeine-free · Easy

INGREDIENTS

300 ml	water
2 tbsp	dried lemongrass
3 slices	ginger
1 tsp	honey
1 wheel	lime

Finish. Lime wheel on the rim.

METHOD

1. Simmer the ginger in the water for 3 min.
2. Turn off, add the lemongrass and steep 5 min, covered.
3. Strain, sweeten and finish with the lime wheel.

BARISTA TIP Dried lemongrass needs very hot water and a lid: the leaves are fibrous and release their aroma slowly.

18 Fresh Garden

Mint and lemongrass: green, fresh, clean.

Hot · 8 min · 1 cup · 250 ml · Caffeine-free · Easy

INGREDIENTS

280 ml	boiling water
1½ tbsp	dried lemongrass
1 bag	mint tea
1 tsp	honey
1 ribbon	lime peel

Finish. A twisted ribbon of lime peel.

METHOD

1. Pour the water over the lemongrass and steep 3 min.
2. Add the mint bag for 3 more min.
3. Strain and sweeten.
4. Twist the peel ribbon over the cup, then drop it in.

BARISTA TIP Twisting the peel over the drink ("expressing") sprays its oils on the surface: a classic bar technique.

19 Serene Trio

Floral, citrus and sweet in balance.

Hot · 8 min · 1 cup · 280 ml · Caffeine-free · Easy

INGREDIENTS

300 ml	water
1 tbsp	chamomile flowers
1 tbsp	dried lemongrass
1 bag	fennel tea
1 tsp	honey

Finish. Chamomile flowers on the natural foam.

METHOD

1. Boil the water, turn off and wait 1 min.
2. Steep everything together for 6 min, covered.
3. Strain and sweeten.

BARISTA TIP A well-built blend has three voices: floral (chamomile), citrus (lemongrass) and sweet (fennel). None should dominate.

20 Chamomile & Charred Lime

Citrus-marmalade notes over chamomile and lemongrass.

Hot · 8 min · 1 cup · 250 ml · Caffeine-free · Intermediate

INGREDIENTS

250 ml	water
1 bag	camomile & lemongrass
1 thick wheel	lime
1 tsp	honey

Finish. The charred wheel inside the cup.

METHOD

1. Heat a dry pan well and char the lime wheel 1 min per side, until marked.
2. Steep the bag in water at ≈ 95 °C for 5 min.
3. Put the charred lime in the cup, sweeten and stir.

BARISTA TIP Charred lime loses its sharp acidity and gains the bitterness of caramelised peel, like marmalade.

21 Chef's Digestif

Menthol, anise and fennel for after dinner.

Hot · 7 min · 1 small cup · 200 ml · Caffeine-free · Easy

INGREDIENTS

250 ml	water
1 bag	mint tea
1 bag	fennel tea
1	star anise
½ tsp	honey (optional)

Finish. Star anise on the saucer.

METHOD

1. Simmer the anise in the water for 2 min.
2. Turn off, add both bags and steep 4 min.
3. Strain and serve in a small cup.

BARISTA TIP Serve a smaller portion, like an after-dinner coffee: it concentrates the experience and marks the ritual.

CHAPTER IV

Hibiscus & Fruit

Ruby & Acidity

Hibiscus and rosehip bring vibrant acidity and intense colour. The barista's job here is balance: honey and apple round off, spices warm, herbs refresh. These are the most beautiful drinks in the guide.

22 Spiced Hot Hibiscus

23 Caribbean Sorrel

24 Rosehip Cherry & Caramelised Apple

25 Minted Ruby

26 Hibiscus Agua Fresca

27 Desert Rose

28 Afternoon Rosé



22 Spiced Hot Hibiscus

Mulled-wine style, alcohol-free: spice, fruit and ruby.

Hot · 12 min · 2 cups · 400 ml · Caffeine-free · Intermediate

INGREDIENTS

400 ml	water
1 tbsp	dried hibiscus flowers
¼	apple, sliced
1 stick	cinnamon stick
1	star anise
2 strips	lime peel
1½ tbsp	honey

Finish. Apple slice and the star anise.

METHOD

1. Simmer the water with the apple, cinnamon, anise and lime peel for 5 min.
2. Turn off, add the hibiscus and steep 4 min.
3. Strain and sweeten.
4. Serve in a glass or glass mug.

BARISTA TIP Serve in glass: the ruby colour is half the experience. A wine glass pre-warmed with hot water looks impeccable.

23 Caribbean Sorrel

Hibiscus, ginger and cinnamon: a Jamaican Christmas tradition.

Hot · 10 min · 1 cup · 250 ml · Caffeine-free · Easy

INGREDIENTS

300 ml	water
1 tbsp	dried hibiscus flowers
1 tsp	grated ginger
1 small stick	cinnamon stick
1 tbsp	honey

Finish. Cinnamon stick as a stirrer.

METHOD

1. Simmer the ginger and cinnamon in the water for 3 min.
2. Turn off, add the hibiscus and steep 4 min.
3. Strain through a fine sieve and sweeten.

BARISTA TIP In Jamaica this combination is called "sorrel" and served at Christmas. Chilled the next day, it is even better.

24 Rosehip Cherry & Caramelised Apple

Tart red fruit over apple in honey syrup.

Hot · 10 min · 1 cup · 250 ml · Caffeine-free · Intermediate

INGREDIENTS

250 ml	water
1 bag	rosehip, hibiscus & cherry
¼	apple, small dice
1 tsp	honey
1 pinch	ground cinnamon

Finish. Apple cubes, with a spoon on the saucer.

METHOD

1. In a small pan, caramelise the apple with the honey for 3 min over medium heat.
2. Add the water and let it boil for 1 min.
3. Turn off, add the bag and steep 5 min.
4. Serve with the apple cubes in the cup and cinnamon on top.

BARISTA TIP Serve with a little spoon: the apple cubes at the end are part of the drink.

25 Minted Ruby

Tart hibiscus with the freshness of mint.

Hot · 6 min · 1 cup · 250 ml · Caffeine-free · Easy

INGREDIENTS

250 ml	boiling water
1 bag	hibiscus tea
1 bag	mint tea
1 tsp	honey
1 wheel	lime

Finish. Lime wheel.

METHOD

1. Steep both bags for 4 min.
2. Remove without squeezing and sweeten.
3. Finish with the lime wheel.

BARISTA TIP Menthol "cools" the perception of acidity: the hibiscus tastes softer than it really is.

26 Hibiscus Agua Fresca

Mexican "agua de jamaica": vibrant, tart and very refreshing.

Iced · 15 min · 2 glasses · 500 ml · Caffeine-free · Easy

INGREDIENTS

2 tbsp	dried hibiscus flowers
250 ml	boiling water
250 ml	ice-cold water
3 tbsp	honey
1	lime (juice)
to taste	ice and apple slices

Finish. Apple slices and hibiscus ice cubes.

METHOD

1. Steep the hibiscus in the boiling water for 5 min. Strain.
2. Dissolve the honey while hot.
3. Top up with the ice-cold water and lime juice.
4. Serve over ice with apple slices.

BARISTA TIP Freeze some of the drink in an ice tray: hibiscus cubes chill without diluting.

27 Desert Rose

Hibiscus rounded off by lemongrass notes.

Hot · 6 min · 1 cup · 250 ml · Caffeine-free · Easy

INGREDIENTS

300 ml	boiling water
1 tsp	dried hibiscus flowers
1 tbsp	dried lemongrass
1 tsp	honey

Finish. A folded lemongrass leaf across the cup.

METHOD

1. Pour the water over the hibiscus and lemongrass.
2. Steep 4 min.
3. Strain and sweeten.

BARISTA TIP Little hibiscus here is intentional: it brings colour and acidity, while lemongrass leads the aroma.

28 Afternoon Rosé

Soft pink: red fruit and chamomile florals.

Hot · 7 min · 1 cup · 250 ml · Caffeine-free · Easy

INGREDIENTS

280 ml	water
1 bag	rosehip, hibiscus & cherry
1 tbsp	chamomile flowers
1 tsp	honey

Finish. Chamomile flowers on the surface.

METHOD

1. Boil the water, turn off and wait 1 min.
2. Steep the bag and chamomile for 5 min, covered.
3. Strain and sweeten.

BARISTA TIP Chamomile softens the fruit and turns the colour rosé, lighter than pure hibiscus.

CHAPTER V

Spices & Tonics

Warmth & Root

Ginger, cinnamon and star anise are decoction ingredients: they need simmering to give everything they have. This chapter gathers elixirs, pure spice tisanes and tea-free drinks where fruit and root are the stars.

29 Ginger, Lime & Honey Elixir

30 Alcohol-free Hot Cider

31 Star Tisane

32 Fire & Ice

33 Iced Ginger Tonic

34 Citrus Orchard



29 Ginger, Lime & Honey Elixir

The classic tonic: spicy, citrusy and honeyed.

Hot · 9 min · 1 cup · 250 ml · Caffeine-free · Easy

INGREDIENTS

300 ml	water
1 tbsp	grated ginger
½	lime (juice)
1 tbsp	honey
1 wheel	lime

Finish. Lime wheel.

METHOD

1. Simmer the ginger in the water for 5 min: the longer, the spicier.
2. Strain through a fine sieve and wait 2 min.
3. Add the honey and lime juice.
4. Finish with the wheel.

BARISTA TIP Grate the ginger skin-on, well washed: the skin carries aroma too. And sweeten when warm: honey in boiling water loses its perfume.

30 Alcohol-free Hot Cider

Stewed apple, cinnamon and anise: pure fruit and spice.

Hot · 25 min · 2 cups · 400 ml · Caffeine-free · Intermediate

INGREDIENTS

500 ml	water
1	apple, diced
2 sticks	cinnamon sticks
1	star anise
2 strips	lime peel
2 tbsp	honey

Finish. Cinnamon stick and an apple slice.

METHOD

1. Simmer everything except the honey, covered, over low heat for 15 min.
2. Lightly mash the apple with a fork and cook 5 more min.
3. Strain, pressing well.
4. Sweeten.

BARISTA TIP A great base: add a black tea or rooibos bag in the last 4 min for a "fortified" version.

31 Star Tisane

Pure anise and cinnamon: sweet, warm, aromatic.

Hot · 9 min · 1 cup · 250 ml · Caffeine-free · Easy

INGREDIENTS

300 ml	water
2	star anise
1 stick	cinnamon stick
1 strip	lime peel
1 tsp	honey

Finish. Both anise stars on the saucer.

METHOD

1. Toast the anise and cinnamon in the dry pan for 30 s.
2. Add the water and lime peel and simmer 6 min, covered.
3. Strain and sweeten.

BARISTA TIP Whole spices need simmering, not steeping. Hot water simply poured over extracts very little.

32 Fire & Ice

Ginger and mint taking turns with every sip.

Hot · 9 min · 1 cup · 250 ml · Caffeine-free · Easy

INGREDIENTS

280 ml	water
4 slices	ginger
1 bag	mint tea
1 tsp	honey

Finish. Ginger slice on the rim.

METHOD

1. Simmer the ginger in the water for 4 min.
2. Turn off, add the mint and steep 4 min.
3. Remove the bag, strain and sweeten.

BARISTA TIP Menthol triggers cold receptors and ginger triggers heat receptors. It is a real sensory contrast, not just flavour.

33 Iced Ginger Tonic

A still ginger ale: spicy, citrusy, refreshing.

Iced · 15 min · 2 glasses · 500 ml · Caffeine-free · Easy

INGREDIENTS

300 ml	water
2 tbsp	grated ginger
3 tbsp	honey
1	lime (juice)
200 ml	ice-cold water
to taste	ice

Finish. Lime wheel and a ginger slice.

METHOD

1. Simmer the ginger in the water for 8 min. Strain through a fine sieve.
2. Dissolve the honey and let it cool.
3. Add the lime juice and ice-cold water.
4. Serve over ice.

BARISTA TIP The concentrate (before the cold water) keeps up to 4 days in the fridge. Try it with iced black tea too.

34 Citrus Orchard

Apple, ginger and lemongrass in layers.

Hot · 12 min · 1 cup · 300 ml · Caffeine-free · Easy

INGREDIENTS

350 ml	water
¼	apple, sliced
3 slices	ginger
1½ tbsp	dried lemongrass
1 tsp	honey

Finish. Apple slice.

METHOD

1. Simmer the apple and ginger in the water for 5 min.
2. Turn off, add the lemongrass and steep 5 min, covered.
3. Strain and sweeten.

BARISTA TIP Layer by extraction time: first what needs simmering (root and fruit), then what is delicate (leaf).

Ginger heat ruler

For 250 ml of water with 1 tbsp fresh ginger. Use this ruler to adjust any recipe in the chapter to your taste.

CUT	SIMMER	HEAT
Thin slices	3 min	Mild
Thin slices	6 min	Medium
Grated	5 min	Intense
Grated	10 min	Very intense

WHY SIMMER?

Ginger's pungent compounds (gingerols) are released by sustained heat. Hot water simply poured over extracts little; simmering extracts for real.

TO SOFTEN

Overdid it? Honey and apple round off the heat. Milk does too, but very fresh ginger can curdle milk if simmered together for long: add milk only at the end.

CHAPTER VI

Creamy

Milk & Comfort

Six recipes with whole milk, 15% of the guide. With no steamer or whisk, the foam comes from "pulling" the drink between two mugs. The secret to all of them: a concentrated base, because milk softens everything it meets.

35 Stovetop Chai

36 Southern Teh Tarik

37 Rooibos Moon Latte

38 Chamomile Moon Milk

39 Lemongrass Fog

40 Creamy Apple Pie



35 Stovetop Chai

Strong black tea, whole spices and creamy milk.

Hot · 12 min · 1 mug · 280 ml · Caffeinated · With milk · Intermediate

INGREDIENTS

150 ml	water
2 bags	black tea
1 stick	cinnamon stick
1	star anise
1 tsp	grated ginger
150 ml	whole milk
1½ tbsp	honey

Finish. Ground cinnamon over the foam.

METHOD

1. Simmer the water with cinnamon, anise and ginger for 5 min.
2. Add the bags and keep at a low simmer for 3 min.
3. Add the milk and heat until tiny bubbles appear at the edges, without boiling.
4. Strain, sweeten and pull between two mugs 4 to 5 times.

BARISTA TIP Two bags, not one: milk "mutes" the tea. The strength must come from the base.

36 Southern Teh Tarik

Malaysia's "pulled tea": frothy, silky, intense.

Hot · 10 min · 1 mug · 250 ml · Caffeinated · With milk · Technique

INGREDIENTS

2 bags	black tea
150 ml	boiling water
120 ml	whole milk
1½ tbsp	honey

Finish. The foam itself, nothing on top.

METHOD

1. Steep the bags in the water for 5 min: a strong concentrate. Remove.
2. Heat the milk with the honey until steaming.
3. Combine tea and milk in one mug.
4. Pour into another mug, from higher each time (up to 30 to 40 cm), 6 to 8 times. The foam forms through aeration.

BARISTA TIP Start low and rise gradually. Use mugs with handles, over the sink, and keep the lower mug tilted.

37 Rooibos Moon Latte

A caffeine-free latte: wood, honey and vanilla.

Hot · 10 min · 1 mug · 250 ml · Caffeine-free · With milk · Intermediate

INGREDIENTS

150 ml	water
2 servings	rooibos moon
150 ml	whole milk
1 tbsp	honey
1 pinch	ground cinnamon

Finish. A half-moon of ground cinnamon on the foam.

METHOD

1. Simmer the rooibos in the water over low heat for 5 min (concentrate).
2. Heat the milk with the honey, without boiling.
3. Strain the rooibos into the mug and add the milk.
4. Pull 4 to 5 times and dust with cinnamon.

BARISTA TIP Rooibos is the "espresso" of caffeine-free lattes: it handles high concentration and simmering without bitterness.

38 Chamomile Moon Milk

Chamomile steeped straight into milk: floral and velvety.

Hot · 10 min · 1 mug · 220 ml · Caffeine-free · With milk · Easy

INGREDIENTS

200 ml	whole milk
50 ml	water
2 tbsp	chamomile flowers
1	star anise (optional)
1 tsp	honey
1 pinch	ground cinnamon

Finish. Ground cinnamon and one chamomile flower.

METHOD

1. Heat the milk with the water until steaming and turn off.
2. Add the chamomile (and anise) and steep 6 min, covered.
3. Strain through a fine sieve, pressing the flowers.
4. Sweeten, reheat if needed and dust with cinnamon.

BARISTA TIP The fat in whole milk captures chamomile's aromas differently from water: the result is rounder.

39 Lemongrass Fog

A tropical London Fog: black tea, lemongrass and milk.

Hot · 9 min · 1 mug · 250 ml · Caffeinated · With milk · Intermediate

INGREDIENTS

150 ml	boiling water
1 bag	black tea
1½ tbsp	dried lemongrass
120 ml	whole milk
1 tbsp	honey

Finish. Smooth foam, no garnish.

METHOD

1. Steep the lemongrass and black tea for 4 min. Strain.
2. Heat the milk with the honey without boiling.
3. Add to the tea and pull 4 to 5 times between two mugs.

BARISTA TIP Never use lime here: acid plus milk curdles. Lemongrass brings citrus without acidity.

40 Creamy Apple Pie

Caramelised apple, rooibos and milk: dessert in a mug.

Hot · 14 min · 1 mug · 250 ml · Caffeine-free · With milk · Intermediate

INGREDIENTS

¼	apple, small dice
1 tbsp	honey
120 ml	water
1 stick	cinnamon stick
1 serving	rooibos moon
150 ml	whole milk
1 pinch	ground cinnamon

Finish. Caramelised apple cubes and cinnamon.

METHOD

1. Caramelise the apple with the honey for 2 min. Add the water and cinnamon and simmer 4 min.
2. Turn off, add the rooibos and steep 5 min.
3. Strain and add the milk, warmed without boiling.
4. Pull 4 to 5 times and finish with ground cinnamon.

BARISTA TIP Save a few caramelised apple cubes to place on the foam as a topping.

Foam without equipment

Pulling the tea (as in Malaysian teh tarik) aerates the milk with no steamer or whisk.

1

TWO MUGS

Use mugs with handles, ideally wide-mouthed. Work over the sink.

2

TEMPERATURE

Hot, steaming milk, but not boiling (≈ 65 to 70 °C). Boiled milk foams poorly and tastes cooked.

3

START LOW

Pour from one mug to the other at about 10 cm, letting the stream fall in the centre.

4

RISE GRADUALLY

With each pass, move the mugs further apart, up to 30 to 40 cm. 6 to 8 passes make a light foam.

ALTERNATIVE

Alternative: a lidded jar. Warm (not hot) milk to half a glass jar, lid tightly closed, wrap in a cloth and shake for 30 s. Open slowly, away from your face. Never use very hot liquid in a closed container.

NOTE

Milk and acid do not mix. Lime and hibiscus curdle milk. In the creamy drinks, citrus comes in only as aroma (lemongrass, dried peel), never as juice.

REFERENCE

Index by ingredient

Want to use what is running low, or what you just bought? Find the ingredient and follow the numbers.

INGREDIENT	USES	RECIPES
Rooibos moon	9	08 · 09 · 10 · 11 · 12 · 13 · 14 · 37 · 40
Black tea	10	01 · 02 · 03 · 04 · 05 · 06 · 07 · 35 · 36 · 39
Chamomile (flowers)	6	14 · 15 · 16 · 19 · 28 · 38
Lemongrass	7	05 · 17 · 18 · 19 · 27 · 34 · 39
Hibiscus flowers	5	04 · 22 · 23 · 26 · 27
Hibiscus (bags)	1	25
Mint (bags)	4	18 · 21 · 25 · 32
Fennel (bags)	4	07 · 12 · 19 · 21
Rosehip, hibiscus & cherry	3	10 · 24 · 28
Camomile & lemongrass	1	20
Star anise	9	01 · 07 · 12 · 21 · 22 · 30 · 31 · 35 · 38
Cinnamon sticks	10	01 · 03 · 08 · 13 · 22 · 23 · 30 · 31 · 35 · 40
Ground cinnamon	8	02 · 08 · 11 · 16 · 24 · 37 · 38 · 40
Ginger	9	03 · 11 · 17 · 23 · 29 · 32 · 33 · 34 · 35
Lime	17	03 · 04 · 05 · 06 · 09 · 14 · 15 · 17 · 18 · 20 · 22 · 25 · 26 · 29 · 30 · 31 · 33
Apple	11	02 · 08 · 10 · 13 · 16 · 22 · 24 · 26 · 30 · 34 · 40
Whole milk	6	35 · 36 · 37 · 38 · 39 · 40

Honey appears in all 40 recipes, almost always optional or adjustable.

Once you master the bases, swap one layer at a time: another fruit, another spice, another time. That is how house recipes are born.



Thank you for brewing with us

The Botanora collection has ten guides, each devoted to one way of living with tea. Keep exploring:

02 The Tea Atlas
03 The Night Ritual
04 Focus & Energy
05 Iced & Cold Brew
06 Matcha at Home
07 Backyard Herbs
08 Crafting Blends
09 Tea & Table
10 Yerba Mate

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